Our playground was a walled concrete rectangle measuring no more than five metres by ten, though it seemed much bigger. I longed for Thursday afternoons, when cathedral services were replaced by football or cricket in Regent's Park. We resumed Evensong on Friday and had a long morning rehearsal on Saturday before a four-hour window to meet our parents. We sang in three services on Sunday, including Choral Matins and Sung Eucharist.

There are parallels here with professional cricket. The choir school, founded with the cathedral in 604 and instituted in its modern form in 1123, when eight boys in need of alms were taken in and educated, has the same reverence for history and tradition. You are expected to be a team player, to commit to a common creed of dedication and self-discipline. The world is often watching.

It is always interesting to search for the man by studying photographs of the boy. I'm on duty, conscious of the camera, during a promotional shot in the cathedral alongside Dame Kiri Te Kanawa. I'm second from the left in the front row, dressed in a black surplice with a red sash and white ruff. Two hands on the lit candle, just in case.

That's one representation of me. The other emerges in classroom shots, where my grey shirt is untucked and my tie has ridden above the collar. Let's just say my blazer has growing room. Another picture has me, eyes on the ball, executing what looks suspiciously like a slog sweep on the way to scoring 110 out of a total of 127 for the choir's cricket team.

When that was taken, I was a novice in a world of international tours, performances in front of royalty, Proms and recording sessions. I relished the freedom of holidays and developed enduring resilience, but as I grew older, began to question the sheltered nature of life. Playing representative cricket for London Schools was a release, though cathedral staff were none too happy when it led to an invitation to an England training camp over Easter.

Music was similar to cricket in that we were judged collectively, but vulnerable to individual error. St Paul's is a hard place to sing, because it has an eight-second echo in the dome, and if one of the thirty choristers makes a fractional misjudgement it can all fall apart. The choir master, and the professionals with whom we were surrounded, would not have been amused.